PREMIUM COURSE MATERIAL

MODULE 8
LESSON 1

Understanding Platform Bans & Shadowbans

Learn the essentials of understanding platform bans & shadowbans

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LESSON 1: UNDERSTANDING PLATFORM BANS & SHADOWBANS

There are two types of bans: visible bans and invisible bans. Visible bans are when the platform tells you directly. Invisible bans (shadowbans) are far more dangerous because you will not know it happened until your growth flatlines. Understanding both is critical to protecting your accounts.

> **THE 2025 INSTAGRAM AI MODERATION SHIFT**
>
> In 2025, Meta deployed LLaMA-based AI moderation that fundamentally changed the landscape. This system is hyper-sensitive to AI-generated content and caused a mass ban wave from May through August 2025. Key implications: Instagram actively flags AI-generated images, IMEI/device bans can affect ALL accounts linked to a banned phone, and false positives are common (even legitimate accounts get caught). This is not going away — it is the new normal. Every safety habit in this module exists because of this reality.

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Types of Platform Actions

- Content removal — single post taken down (warning level)
- Temporary restriction — limited features for 24-72 hours
- Shadowban — content stops being shown to non-followers (invisible, most dangerous)
- Account suspension — temporary lockout requiring appeal
- Permanent ban — account deleted, usually not recoverable
- Device/IMEI ban — ALL accounts on that device are affected (Instagram-specific, post-2025)

Shadowban Detection

A shadowban will NOT show a notification. Your content simply stops reaching new people. The only way to detect it is by monitoring your metrics daily.

- Instagram: Check Insights — if 'reach from non-followers' drops to near zero, you are likely shadowbanned
- Instagram: Check Account Status in Settings → Account → Account Status weekly for any flags
- TikTok: If views suddenly drop from thousands to double digits, check notifications for content violations
- Twitter/X: Check account health at shadowban.yuzurisa.com — warmup continues until ALL indicators are green
- Reddit: If your posts get zero upvotes consistently in subreddits where they used to perform, you may be site-wide shadowbanned

IMAGE PLACEHOLDER

Instagram Insights comparison: Left shows healthy reach (steady 'reach from non-followers' graph). Right shows shadowbanned reach (graph drops to near zero). Annotate the difference clearly.

EARLY DETECTION RULE

By the time you notice a shadowban, it has usually been active for days. Check your metrics every single day. Early detection means faster recovery. Late detection means weeks of lost growth.

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What Triggers Flags

- Posting suggestive content too early (no trust built)
- Aggressive follow/unfollow behavior (bot-like patterns)
- Spam-like posting patterns (too much, too fast)
- Link sharing during warmup phase
- Multiple accounts on same device/IP behaving identically
- Reports from other users
- AI-generated content detected by platform moderation
- Using banned hashtags on Instagram
- Third-party apps that require Instagram login

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END SUMMARY

- Instagram's 2025 AI moderation shift permanently changed the landscape — prepare for flagging and have backups
- Shadowbans are invisible — monitor reach from non-followers daily to detect them early
- Prevention beats recovery: daily trust signals, safe content, and platform rate limits keep accounts healthy
- If shadowbanned: stop posting, go passive for 48-72 hours, resume at 50% frequency
- If permanently banned: start fresh with new device, new persona, new everything — rebuild smarter
- Device/IMEI bans affect ALL accounts on that phone — you may need a completely new device
- Always keep backup accounts warming up and content backed up locally and in the cloud
- Multi-account safety requires complete separation: device, IP, email, phone number — no exceptions
- If one account gets banned, quarantine all other accounts for 72 hours minimum
- Use appeal templates that are short, polite, and non-confrontational — never argue or threaten

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